



1st Multi-Sectoral Consultative Committee on Tuition Fees (MSCCTF) Minutes of the Meeting

The meeting was called to order by DLSU PUSO on November 19, 2025 2:00 PM via Zoom	
DATE	November 19, 2025
TIME	2:00 PM
SCRIBE	Lucas Antonio V Tujan , <i>USG Executive Secretary</i>

ATTENDANCE	
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR ADMIN	Dr. Robert Roleda Ms. Kai Shan Fernandez
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR AFED	Dr. David Michael San Juan Mr. Rommel Billena
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR PUSO	Ms. Maria Lourdes Fajardo Ms. Maela Lumabas Ms. Shiela Nacpil Ms. Rosalyn Villano
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR USG	Ms. Lara Capps Ms. Lucas Antonio Tujan Mr. Jeian Ruiz Nicol Ms. Micah Agatha Dimatulac
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR OUR	Dr. Nelson Marcos

AGENDA SUMMARY

- VIII. Invocation - USG
- A. Ms. Micah Dimatulac of the University Student Government (USG) led the opening prayer.
- IX. Call to Order
- A. The Chair, Ms. Maria Lourdes Fajardo, officially called the meeting to order.
- B. The Executive Secretary requested the representatives from each sector to introduce themselves to the body.
1. Dr. Robert Roleda (Provost), Ms. Kai Shan Fernandez (Senior Vice President), and Mr. Jirk Jansen Miranda (Vice President for Finance) represented the Admin Sector.
2. Dr. David Michael San Juan, Mr. Rommel Billena, and Dr. Dickson Lim represented the AFED Sector.
3. The Chair called for the EA representatives but noted that no representatives from the Employees Association (EA) Sector were present.
4. Ms. Lara Ysabelle Capps, Mr. Jeian Ruiz Nicol, Ms. Micah Agatha Dimatulac, and Mr. Lucas Antonio Tujan represented the USG Sector.
5. Ms. Maria Lourdes Fajardo (President), Ms. Maela Lumabas (Board Secretary), Ms. Shiela Nacpil (Vice President for Internals), and Ms. Rosalyn Villano (Alternate) represented the PUSO Sector.
- C. The Chair requested the meeting guests to introduce themselves.
1. Dr. Nelson Marcos represented the Office of the University Registrar (OUR) and announced that the ongoing consultations should conclude by the end of February to prepare the necessary documents for submission to the Commission on Higher Education (CHED).

X. Reading and Approval of the Implementing Rules and Regulations (IRR) AY 2024-2025

- A. The Executive Secretary presented the Implementing Rules and Regulations (IRR) and the Chair opened the floor for amendments or comments.
- B. Dr. Robert Roleda proposed a revision to Article II, Section 2, noting that the position of "Chancellor" is non-existent under the current organizational structure.
 1. Dr. Roleda moved to replace the phrase "Brother President/Chancellor" with "Brother President/Provost".
 2. Mr. Rommel Billena seconded the motion.
 3. The Chair called for a vote, heard no objections, and approved the amendment.
- C. Dr. Robert Roleda moved to approve the Implementing Rules and Regulations as a whole, as amended.
 1. Ms. Lara Capps seconded the motion.
 2. The Chair declared the Implementing Rules and Regulations (IRR) for AY 2025-2026 approved.

XI. Discussions/Manifestation/Motion

- A. The Chair opened the floor for discussions regarding the schedule of the next meetings.
 1. The Chair stated that the order of presentations shall be AFED, EA, USG, PUSO, and Admin according to the IRR.
 2. The Chair announced that meetings will take place every Wednesday and the schedule resumes on January 7, 2026 with the AFED presentation.
 3. Ms. Lara Capps raised a motion to make the USG the last presenter to allow more time for gathering information for their proposal, but the Chair noted that the Admin is traditionally the last presenter.
 4. Ms. Capps inquired if the USG could be the 4th presenter.
 5. Dr. Robert Roleda noted that this implies PUSO would become the 3rd presenter and the Chair initially agreed to this arrangement.
 6. Dr. Roleda asked the USG to reconsider, suggesting that PUSO traditionally reviews the USG presentation before making their own presentation and that the placement of USG before PUSO is more optimal.
 7. Ms. Capps agreed to retain the original order of presentations as stated in the IRR.
- B. The Chair opened the discussion regarding the weekly meeting time.
 1. The Chair asked if the 2 PM weekly meeting time was still acceptable to the body.
 2. Mr. Billena proposed moving the schedule to 4 PM.
 3. Dr. Roleda remarked that 4 PM might be too late in the afternoon and suggested 3 PM as a compromise.
 4. The USG and PUSO sectors expressed agreement with the 3 PM schedule and Mr. Billena agreed to the 3 PM schedule starting January 7, 2026.

XII. Schedule of Next Meeting

- A. The final order of presentations and dates were declared by the Chair with meetings held at 3 PM.
 1. AFED Presentation will be on January 7, 2026.
 2. EA Presentation will be on January 14, 2026.
 3. USG Presentation will be on January 21, 2026.
 4. PUSO Presentation will be on January 28, 2026.
 5. Admin Presentation will be on February 4, 2026.

XIII. Other Matters

- A. The Chair opened the floor for other matters.
 1. The Chair stated that the USG is permitted to bring assistants to attend future meetings but clarified they are not allowed to join any discussions.

XIV. Adjournment

- A. Dr. Robert Roleda moved to adjourn the meeting.
- B. The motion was seconded by Dr. David San Juan.
- C. The meeting was adjourned.



UNIVERSITY STUDENT GOVERNMENT

Prepared by:


Mr. Lucas Antonio Tujan
USG Executive Secretary
DLSU USG

Noted and Validated by:

Ms. Maria Lourdes Fajardo
Chairperson, MSCCTF
President and CEO
DLSU-PUSO

2nd Multi-Sectoral Consultative Committee on Tuition Fees (MSCCTF) Minutes of the Meeting

The meeting was called to order by **DLSU PUSO** on
January 7, 2026 3:30 PM via **Zoom**

DATE	January 7, 2026
TIME	3:30 PM
SCRIBE	Lucas Antonio V Tujan, <i>USG Executive Secretary</i>

ATTENDANCE	
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR ADMIN	Dr. Robert Roleda Ms. Kai Shan Fernandez Mr. Jirk Jansen Miranda
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR AFED	Dr. David Michael San Juan Mr. Rommel Billena
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR EA	Mr. John Perez IV Ms. Marileth Recaido Ms. Pinky Villanueva
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR PUSO	Ms. Maria Lourdes Fajardo Ms. Maela Lumabas Ms. Shiela Nacpil Ms. Rosalyn Villano
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR USG	Ms. Lara Capps Ms. Lucas Antonio V Tujan Mr. Jeian Ruiz Nicol Ms. Micah Agatha Dimatulac

AGENDA SUMMARY

- Invocation - AFED**
 - Mr. Rommel Billena of the The Association of Faculty and Educators of DLSU, Inc. (AFED) led the opening prayer.
- Call to Order**
 - The Chair, Ms. Maria Lourdes Fajardo, officially called the meeting to order at 3:30 PM via Zoom.
- Reading and Approval of the Minutes of the 1st MSCCTF Meeting 19 November 2025**
 - Mr. Tujan, USG Executive Secretary, read the minutes of the 1st MSCCTF meeting held on 19 November 2025.
 - Dr. Robert Roleda approved the minutes, with the motion seconded by Mr. Rommel Billena.
 - The minutes were approved.
 - The Chair requested the Executive Secretary to conduct the roll call.
 - Dr. Dickson Lim was noted as absent due to being on Leave of Absence and will be replaced at a later date.
 - The Executive Secretary requested the Employees Association (EA) representatives to introduce themselves, as they were not present during the previous meeting.
 - The Employee Association was represented by Mr. John Perez as President, Ms. Marileth Recaido as Vice President, and Ms. Pinky Villanueva as Secretary.
- Association of Faculty Educators of DLSU, Inc. (AFED) Proposal/Presentation**
 - The Chair invited the AFED representatives to present their proposal.

- 4.2. Mr. San Juan presented the AFED proposal approved by its Board.
 - 4.2.1. AFED proposed a 6% Tuition Fee Increase (TFI) for AY 2026–2027 to support salary increases and facility upgrades.
 - 4.2.2. AFED cited Section 5 of R.A. 6728, stating that 70% of TFI proceeds must be allocated to salaries and benefits, and 20% to facilities and operations.
 - 4.2.3. AFED emphasized the need for salary increases to remain competitive, noting that DLSU faculty compensation per unit is lower than the UP System, particularly for Associate and Senior Lecturers.
 - 4.2.4. AFED stressed on the large gap between the average compression per unit between DLSU and UP, noting Php 4,035 - Php 7,906 for Instructors; Php 24 - Php 5,589 for Assistant Professors; Php 3,409 - Php 14,091 for Associate Professors; and Php 12,920 - Php 16,609 for Full Professors.
 - 4.2.5. AFED noted that the gaps are higher for DLSU's Associate and Senior Lecturers against UP's Instructors and Assistant/Associate Professions with Php 9,208 - Php 14,451 for Associate Lecture 1-10; Php 7,080 - Php 51,628 for Senior Lecturer 1-20.
 - 4.2.6. AFED also noted that for part-timers, the gap for hourly rate between UP and DLSU is from Php 156 - Php 896.
 - 4.2.7. AFED reiterates its request for the University to swiftly transition again to an across-the-board salary increase.
 - 4.2.8. AFED hopes that the TFI proceeds could be used to fund the opening of new full-time positions for faculty and ASF.
 - 4.2.9. AFED recommends that the Administration provide an update on the FT-PT ratios per department to identify the need for PT-FT positions.
 - 4.2.10. The need for additional staffing in the Finance and Accounting Office (FAO) was noted due to challenges arising from enrollment system transitions.
 - 4.2.11. AFED presented a faculty facilities wish list, highlighting priorities such as classroom equipment, IT infrastructure, laboratories, ventilation, accessibility, and safety improvements.
 - 4.2.12. AFED cited inflation forecasts ranging from 3.0% to 3.5%, noting risks of higher inflation due to national and international instability.
 - 4.2.13. AFED argued that economic, political, and geopolitical risks justify a higher buffer, supporting the proposed 6% TFI.
 - 4.2.14. AFED cited Section 5 of R.A. No. 6728 stating that "schools shall maintain a separate record of accounts for all assistance received from the government, any tuition fee increase, and the detailed disposition and use thereof, which record shall be made available for period inspection... during business hours, by the faculty, the non-teaching personnel, students of the school concerned..."
 - 4.2.15. AFED emphasized the need for transparency, requesting disclosure of past TFI utilization, miscellaneous fees spending, infrastructure costs, consultancies, and investment fund income.
 - 4.2.16. AFED recommends that before any sectoral presentations, the Administration be compelled first to present data on the separate record of accounts on past tuition fee increase, and the detailed disposition and use thereof, as well as a report on the collection and spending of miscellaneous fees and other fees.
 - 4.2.17. AFED highlights the need for transparency regarding recent infrastructure work and consultancies.
 - 4.2.18. AFED requests for transparency on the income generated by the University's investment fund.
 - 4.2.19. AFED supported the USG's request for updates on previously raised concerns, including system efficiency issues (e.g., Animo Sys, MLS).
 - 4.2.20. AFED notes that the reduced campus and laboratory utilization due to the hybrid set up of most classes should theoretically mean a reduction of energy consumption. AFED hopes for data on this matter could be provided by the Administration.
 - 4.2.21. AFED proposed forming a Multisectoral Committee to study other ways to generate income and optimize spending to explore alternative income generation and spending optimization, with the goal of reducing reliance on annual TFIs.

5. Discussions/Manifestation/Motion

- 5.1. The Chair opened the floor for discussions regarding the schedule of the next meetings.
- 5.2. The USG stated that a 6% tuition fee increase is not ideal and unjustifiable.
 - 5.2.1. The USG noted that the proposed increase is nearly double the projected inflation rate of 3–3.2%.
 - 5.2.2. The USG expressed concern that the increase may negatively affect student enrollment.
- 5.3. Ms. Dimatulac of USG cited a gradual decline in enrollment in previous school years.
 - 5.3.1. She questioned the necessity of hiring additional faculty amid declining enrollment.
 - 5.3.2. The USG stated that it would further elaborate on these concerns upon availability of supporting data.
- 5.4. The Chair inquired on AFED's request for data regarding tuition fee increases.
 - 5.4.1. The administration confirmed that the requested data may be prepared.

- 5.4.2. The data shall include incremental proceeds from tuition fee increases for the past three years.
- 5.4.3. The data shall show allocations for salaries and benefits and non-salary operating expenses.
- 5.4.4. The administration clarified that spending exceeds the amount generated by tuition fee increases.
- 5.5. It was agreed that the data shall be limited to tuition fee increases only.
 - 5.5.1. Miscellaneous and other fees were excluded from the discussion.
 - 5.5.2. Computation shall follow the Supreme Court-prescribed formula.
- 5.6. The administration committed to provide the requested data by the following week.
- 5.7. AFED raised concerns on the lack of representation in discussions on miscellaneous fees.
 - 5.7.1. The administration clarified that miscellaneous fees are allocated for specific purposes only.
 - 5.7.2. It was noted that proposals for fee changes originate at the departmental level with faculty representation.
 - 5.7.3. The administration also clarified that there is already a committee on fees and they present this data to the students.
- 5.8. The USG sought clarification on whether students were consulted regarding miscellaneous and other fees.
 - 5.8.1. The administration referred to the committee earlier identified, noting that the meeting has not yet been convened.
 - 5.8.2. The administration stated that, in previous years, students were consulted regarding miscellaneous and other fees.
- 5.9. The Employee Association (EA) representative raised concerns regarding the reservation fee implemented in the previous academic year.
 - 5.9.1. The EA cited confusion among employee-parents regarding the imposition of a separate reservation fee amounting to approximately PHP 10,000.
 - 5.9.2. The EA requested clarification on the number of students who paid the reservation fee and whether the amount was deducted from tuition.
 - 5.9.3. The EA noted feedback from parents and employees claiming that the reservation fee was not deducted from tuition payments.
- 5.10. The administration clarified that the reservation fee is not a new fee.
 - 5.10.1. The administration explained that certain special and other fees were temporarily transferred under the reservation fee.
 - 5.10.2. It was clarified that the reservation fee was reflected as a reduction in the Term 1 assessment, not as a direct deduction from tuition payment.
 - 5.10.3. The administration stated that the total amount paid by students remained unchanged, with only the accounting process differing.
- 5.11. The administration announced that beginning the next academic year, the university will revert to the previous practice.
 - 5.11.1. The reservation fee shall again be treated as an advance payment applied to the Term 1 assessment of freshmen.
 - 5.11.2. As a result, Term 1 assessments will reflect higher amounts, with the reservation fee deducted upon payment.
- 5.12. The administration clarified that the reservation fee is non-refundable.
 - 5.12.1. It was emphasized that confirmation and reservation fees have always been non-refundable in accordance with existing policy.
- 5.13. The EA requested that future changes to fee implementation be discussed with stakeholders prior to implementation.
 - 5.13.1. The administration explained that the previous change was made in anticipation of the Archer's Hub system.
 - 5.13.2. The administration stated that the system can accommodate the old practice, prompting the reversion.
- 5.14. The USG sought clarification if the ID 124 students experienced this system of advanced payment
 - 5.14.1. The administration clarifies that the reservation fee contains components of the miscellaneous and other feed. During the assessment, the payment for miscellaneous fees have been deducted.
- 5.15. The EA clarifies if there is a record of these changes and an explanation to the advantages and disadvantages of changing the system
 - 5.15.1. The administration mentions the change was brought by the anticipation of archers hub in simplifying the process.
- 5.16. The Chair stated that the concerns raised by the EA had been clarified and may still be discussed informally after the meeting.
- 5.17. The Chair directed the administration to prioritize the presentation of AFED's requested data in the next meeting.
 - 5.17.1. The administration shall present the financial statement and the breakdown of tuition fee increases for the past three years.
 - 5.17.2. The presentation shall be made at the start of the next meeting, prior to the EA presentation.
 - 5.17.3. The administration confirmed that the requested data are also required by CHED.

- 5.18. A query was raised regarding the possibility of implementing tuition fee increases on a non-annual basis.
 - 5.18.1. The administration responded that such matters will be addressed in the forthcoming proposal.
- 5.19. The administration provided clarification on CHED guidelines regarding tuition fee increases.
 - 5.19.1. It was stated that CHED issues an annual memorandum on acceptable tuition fee increases.
 - 5.19.2. The allowable increase is typically pegged to the previous year's inflation rate and may vary by region.
 - 5.19.3. It was noted that the expected CHED directive for the upcoming year may be around 1.8%, subject to official issuance.
- 5.20. The USG raised a clarification regarding a distributed document stating that the reservation or admission fee for ID 124 was not an advance payment for enrollment.
 - 5.20.1. The administration acknowledged the concern and stated that further clarification would be provided in the next meeting due to time constraints.
 - 5.20.2. Under the reverted system, the reservation fee is treated as a confirmation fee and an advance payment applied to enrollment assessment.
- 5.21. The USG representative presented additional comments on the proposed tuition fee increase.
 - 5.21.1. The USG noted a declining enrollment trend following tuition fee increases.
 - 5.21.2. It was stated that a 6% increase is equivalent to an increase of approximately PHP 250.50 per unit.
 - 5.21.3. The USG cited an estimated increase of PHP 4,509 for an 18-unit load and PHP 5,260 for a 21-unit load.
 - 5.21.4. Based on a previous USG survey, the increase may lead students to consider leave of absence or reconsider enrollment.
- 5.22. The USG suggested expanding salary and wage comparisons to include other private universities.
 - 5.22.1. Suggested comparators included universities with similar academic calendars, such as trisemestral institutions.
- 5.23. The USG expressed appreciation should the administration present first in future MSCCTF meetings.
 - 5.23.1. It was noted that early administrative presentation may assist sectors in preparing their respective submissions.
- 5.24. The administration explained the rationale for presenting last in MSCCTF proceedings.
 - 5.24.1. It was stated that the administration traditionally presents after hearing sectoral proposals.
 - 5.24.2. This practice was clarified as part of the university's multisectoral deliberation process.
- 5.25. The Chair emphasized that all sectors are given equal opportunity to comment prior to deliberation.
 - 5.25.1. It was stated that the final tuition fee decision may range from no increase to varying percentage increases.
- 5.26. AFED recommended that the early presentation of financial data on previous tuition fee increases be placed on record.
 - 5.26.1. AFED suggested that data on collections and expenditures be presented at the first meeting.
 - 5.26.2. The recommendation was cited as consistent with transparency provisions under existing regulations.
- 5.27. AFED responded to the USG's explanation on the comparison of faculty compensation with UP.
 - 5.27.1. AFED mentions that with regards to the quality of education, the bench mark is not just UP but also 1st-world country universities.
 - 5.27.2. AFED mentions that UP has clear standards regarding compensation and wants DLSU to have similar standards.
- 5.28. The Chair acknowledged AFED's request regarding the early posting of requested documents.
 - 5.28.1. The Chair requested all sectors to submit their respective document requests for possible inclusion in the first meeting agenda.
 - 5.28.2. It was suggested that a formal motion be made after deliberation to institutionalize the early posting of approved documents.
- 5.29. The Employee Association (EA) raised a concern regarding comments made about its presentations.
 - 5.29.1. The EA requested that sectors refrain from making disparaging remarks about other sectors and maintain mutual respect.
 - 5.29.2. The EA clarified that it independently prepares and presents its proposals.
- 5.30. AFED responded to the EA's concern.
 - 5.30.1. AFED stated that it was not aware of the comments raised during the meeting.
 - 5.30.2. AFED committed to addressing and discouraging such remarks within its internal channels.
- 5.31. The Chair noted the concern raised by the EA and encouraged respectful discourse among all sectors.
 - 5.31.1. The Chair confirmed that the EA will present in the next meeting.
- 5.32. The USG requested further clarification on the confirmation/reservation fee.
 - 5.32.1. The USG requested data showing where the confirmation fee was allocated, citing inconsistencies in information provided to ID 124.

- 5.32.2. The USG requested verification and supporting documents to establish whether the fee was treated as an advance payment or reflected through assessment adjustments.
- 5.33. The administration agreed to provide supporting data.
 - 5.33.1. The administration committed to presenting a breakdown of the components of the reservation/confirmation fee.
 - 5.33.2. A sample anonymized Enrollment Assessment Form (EAF) for ID 124 shall be generated for comparison.
 - 5.33.3. Comparative samples from ID 123 and ID 125 may also be presented to illustrate differences in assessment treatment.
- 5.34. The Chair directed that the requested data be presented at the start of the next meeting
 - 5.34.1. The presentation shall be made prior to sectoral presentations to ensure clarity.
 - 5.34.2. The Chair noted that the process has since reverted to the confirmation fee system.
- 5.35. The administration announced updates on enrollment systems.
 - 5.35.1. Archer's Hub for undergraduate students shall go live the following week.
 - 5.35.2. Existing systems (MLS and AnimoSys) shall be retired.
 - 5.35.3. The USG shall be requested to provide student volunteers to test the system prior to Term 2.
- 5.36. The USG requested additional financial and student-related data.
 - 5.36.1. Requested documents included the audited financial statements and allocation of tuition fee increase proceeds.
 - 5.36.2. The USG requested data on the student loan program, if available.
 - 5.36.3. The USG requested statistics on promissory note usage in recent years.
 - 5.36.4. The USG requested a breakdown of miscellaneous fees and clarification on the allocation of surcharge and retention fees.
- 5.37. The administration confirmed availability of most requested data.
 - 5.37.1. The audited financial statements were confirmed to be available and shall be shared.
 - 5.37.2. Data on promissory notes and miscellaneous fee schedules shall be provided.
 - 5.37.3. Availability of data on the student loan program shall be verified
- 5.38. The Chair noted that financial data are consistently requested during MSCCTF meetings.
 - 5.38.1. It was agreed that financial statements and tuition fee increase allocations shall be presented at the start of future MSCCTF cycles.
- 5.39. No further comments or requests were raised by the sectors.

6. Other Matters

- 6.1. No other matters were raised.

7. Schedule of Next Meeting

- 7.1. The next MSCCTF meeting will be scheduled for 3:00 PM, January 14, 2026.

8. Adjournment

- 8.1. Dr. Robert Roleda moved to adjourn the meeting.
- 8.2. The motion was duly seconded by Dr. David San Juan.
- 8.3. The Chair declared the meeting adjourned.



UNIVERSITY STUDENT GOVERNMENT

Prepared by:


Mr. Lucas Antonio Tujan
USG Executive Secretary
DLSU USG

Noted and Validated by:

Ms. Maria Lourdes Fajardo
Chairperson, MSCCTF
President and CEO
DLSU-PUSO

3rd Multi-Sectoral Consultative Committee on Tuition Fees (MSCCTF) Minutes of the Meeting

The meeting was called to order by **DLSU PUSO** on
January 14, 2026 3:00 PM via **Zoom**

DATE	January 14, 2026
TIME	3:00 PM
SCRIBE	Lucas Antonio V Tujan, <i>USG Executive Secretary</i>

ATTENDANCE	
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR ADMIN	Dr. Robert Roleda Ms. Kai Shan Fernandez Mr. Jirk Jansen Miranda
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR AFED	Dr. David Michael San Juan Mr. Rommel Billena Dr. Raymond Vergara
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR EA	Mr. John Perez IV Ms. Marileth Recaido Ms. Pinky Villanueva
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR PUSO	Ms. Maria Lourdes Fajardo Ms. Maela Lumabas Ms. Shiela Nacpil Ms. Rosalyn Villano
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR USG	Ms. Lara Capps Ms. Lucas Antonio Tujan Mr. Jeian Ruiz Nicol Ms. Micah Agatha Dimatulac

AGENDA SUMMARY

1. Invocation

1.1. The Chair initially requested a representative from the Employees’ Association (EA) to lead the invocation.

1.1.1. There was no response from the EA representatives at the time the request was made.

1.2. The invocation was led by Mr. Rommel Billena of the Association of Faculty and Educators of DLSU, Inc. (AFED).
2. Call to Order

2.1. The Chair requested the Executive Secretary to conduct the roll call to establish quorum.

2.1.1. A member of AFED mentioned that Dr. Raymond Vergara would arrive later due to a prior commitment.

2.1.2. Ms. Marileth Ricaido was not present during the roll call, whoever, she entered the meeting later on.

2.2. The Chair called the meeting to order after the completion of the roll call.
3. Reading and Approval of the Minutes of the 2nd MSCCTF Meeting 07 January 2026

3.1. The Chair stated that the minutes of the 2nd MSCCTF meeting held on 07 January 2026 had been circulated prior to the meeting.

- 3.2. The Administration indicated that there were no corrections or objections to the minutes.
- 3.3. The Chair moved for the approval of the minutes, which was duly seconded by the University Student Government (USG).
- 3.4. The minutes of the 2nd MSCCTF meeting were approved.

4. Business Arising

- 4.1. Before proceeding to the proposal and presentation of the Employees' Association (EA), the Chair stated that the Administration would first discuss the audited financial statements and the data on tuition fee increases, as requested during the previous meeting.
- 4.2. The Chair designated Mr. J.J. to present the said financial data.
- 4.3. Mr. J.J. presented the Statement of Activities, Statement of Financial Position, and Cash Flow Statement.
 - 4.3.1. Total revenue amounted to PHP 7.1 billion, up from PHP 6.9 billion in the previous year, inclusive of unrestricted, UBD, and restricted funds.
 - 4.3.2. Total expenses increased to PHP 6.1 billion from PHP 5.9 billion, mainly due to higher salaries, wages, and benefits, while other expenses remained stable.
 - 4.3.3. The University recorded PHP 1.6 billion in comprehensive income, largely due to a non-cash pension remeasurement gain.
 - 4.3.4. Total assets increased to PHP 17.5 billion, with PPE rising from PHP 7.4 billion to PHP 8.9 billion due to campus investments.
 - 4.3.5. Net pension liabilities decreased from approximately PHP 892 million to PHP 600 million, while accounts payable increased in relation to capital expenditures.
 - 4.3.6. Total net assets rose from PHP 12.0 billion to PHP 13.6 billion, primarily from comprehensive income.
 - 4.3.7. Cash and cash equivalents declined from PHP 3.0 billion to PHP 2.5 billion, reflecting net cash outflows from investing activities, mainly PPE.
 - 4.3.8. The Administration reported a slight increase in student headcount and noted that revenue growth was supported by the AY 2024–2025 tuition fee increase.
 - 4.3.9. The increase in salaries and benefits was attributed to the 3.6% across-the-board salary increase.
- 4.4. An AFED member sought clarification on whether the reported salaries and wages covered all employee groups.
 - 4.4.1. The Administration confirmed that the figures include all sectors, including administrative staff, APSP, and personnel from both Manila and Laguna campuses, including IS.
 - 4.4.2. The AFED member requested a breakdown of salaries and wages, to be presented in a subsequent Administration presentation.
 - 4.4.3. The Administration agreed to include the requested breakdown of salaries and benefits, as well as the impact of incremental tuition fee proceeds, in the next presentation.
- 4.5. A USG member requested clarification on whether there is specific data showing the allocation of tuition fee increases from previous years, noting that the presented figures reflected total tuition revenue without a detailed breakdown of incremental increases.
 - 4.5.1. The Administration explained that tuition revenue and expenses are not matched on a one-to-one basis, and that tuition collections increased from approximately PHP 4.5 billion to PHP 4.8 billion year-on-year.
 - 4.5.2. The Administration stated that the increase in tuition revenue largely offset the increase in salaries and benefits, amounting to approximately PHP 300 million, and that it is fair to state that the incremental proceeds were primarily allocated to salaries and benefits.
 - 4.5.3. The Administration further noted that at least 70% or more of the incremental proceeds were allocated to salaries and benefits, consistent with regulatory requirements.
 - 4.5.4. The Administration clarified that a detailed allocation breakdown of incremental tuition fee proceeds is still being prepared and will be presented in a subsequent meeting.
- 4.6. A USG member inquired whether the Administration has explored alternative revenue-generating sources aside from tuition and fees to support salaries and wages, as previously discussed in earlier MSCCTF consultations.
 - 4.6.1. The Administration stated that there are plans to diversify revenue sources, noting that investment income is currently the most viable potential alternative to tuition and fees.
 - 4.6.2. It was clarified that while investment income presents potential, the University's current investment fund remains relatively small and would require significant time to grow, with associated market risks.

- 4.6.3. The Administration noted that donations and special fund receipts are generally restricted and cannot be readily allocated to salaries and benefits.
- 4.6.4. The Administration explained that private higher education institutions in the Philippines receive limited government support, making tuition and fees the primary revenue source.
- 4.6.5. The Administration further noted that current economic conditions have limited investment returns and donor contributions, though these may improve when market conditions stabilize.
- 4.6.6. The Administration added that efforts are underway to expand revenue through lifelong learning and related initiatives, but emphasized that student enrollment remains the principal driver of University resources.
- 4.7. A USG member requested information on the types of University investments that may serve as potential revenue-generating sources.
 - 4.7.1. The Administration explained that the University's investments are primarily in fixed-income instruments, particularly bonds, with a smaller portion (approximately 25%) allocated to equities.
 - 4.7.2. It was clarified that the performance of these investments depends on market conditions and that the University adopts a conservative investment strategy, consistent with its institutional nature as an educational institution.
 - 4.7.3. The Administration emphasized that the University does not engage in aggressive investment practices and prioritizes capital preservation and stability over higher-risk returns.
- 4.8. A USG member requested clarification on the allocation for Archer's Hub, noting that it was not reflected in the presented financial data.
 - 4.8.1. The Administration clarified that funding for Archer's Hub is sourced from the Information and Communication Technology (ICT) funds and is treated as an IT-related expense, supported by IT revenues and fees.
- 4.9. The Chair noted that the Administration proposal would be presented after all sectoral presentations and raised the pending item on the data on tuition fee increases for the past years, which had been requested in previous meetings.
 - 4.9.1. The Administration acknowledged the request and explained that the detailed breakdown of tuition fee increases was not yet prepared, as the available figures reflect total amounts. The Administration stated that the requested breakdown would be presented in the next meeting to ensure proper explanation.
 - 4.9.2. The Chair agreed that discussion on the audited financial statements may be concluded for the meantime, noting that the Administration would further discuss the matter, including the tuition fee increase data, in its succeeding presentation.
- 4.10. The Administration proceeded to explain the reservation/admission fee collected from incoming freshmen for AY 2024–2025, amounting to PHP 10,000.
 - 4.10.1. The Administration clarified that the PHP 10,000 admission fee consists primarily of previously existing new student fees, including the ID card fee, matriculation fee, orientation fee, physical examination fee, and drug testing fee.
 - 4.10.2. It was emphasized that the admission fee did not constitute an additional fee, but rather a reclassification or renaming of fees that were previously charged during enrollment.
 - 4.10.3. The Administration explained that these fees were collected in advance prior to enrollment and, as a result, were no longer reflected in the Enrollment Assessment Form (EAF) of freshmen for AY 2024–2025.
 - 4.10.4. The Administration stated that the total amount payable by students remained unchanged, with the adjustment affecting only the timing and labeling of the fee collection.
 - 4.10.5. It was further clarified that for ID 124 students, the admission fee covers the said components throughout their stay, whereas earlier batches (ID 123 and below) were charged the same fees at later stages.
- 4.11. An EA member sought clarification on whether the confirmation, admission, and reservation fees are treated as part of tuition and whether such fees are refundable.
 - 4.11.1. The Administration clarified that confirmation, admission, and reservation fees are all non-refundable, regardless of the terminology used.
 - 4.11.2. It was further clarified that while the terms used for the fees differ, the amount and financial effect on students remain the same.
- 4.12. A concern was raised by an EA member regarding confusion among parents and stakeholders due to the varying terminology used to describe the fees.

- 4.12.1. The member recommended that the Administration issue a formal advisory or memorandum to clarify that the different terms refer to the same fee and have the same effect.
- 4.12.2. The Administration noted that the University has reverted to the previous practice regarding the treatment of these fees.
- 4.13. The Administration confirmed that the University has reverted to the confirmation fee system.
 - 4.13.1. The Administration presented the Schedule and Table of Fees for AY 2025–2026, noting that ID 124 students had already paid the admission fee.
 - 4.13.2. It was clarified that for ID 124, fees related to the annual physical examination and drug testing are no longer chargeable in subsequent years, as these were already covered by the admission fee.
 - 4.13.3. The Administration emphasized that any future increases in the annual physical examination and drug testing fees will not apply to ID 124 students until graduation.
 - 4.13.4. The Administration noted that other student batches may still be subject to adjustments in these fees, as they did not pay the admission fee under the same arrangement.
- 4.14. A clarification was raised regarding reports of a refund related to the reservation or confirmation fee, particularly for students currently in their second year.
 - 4.14.1. The Administration clarified that the amount paid as a confirmation fee is not a refund, but an advance payment that is credited against the student's assessed enrollment fees upon enrollment.
 - 4.14.2. It was explained that for ID 123, the PHP 10,000 confirmation fee was deducted from the enrollment assessment, reflecting the advance payment.
 - 4.14.3. The Administration clarified that while the confirmation and admission fees are of the same amount, the difference lies in their treatment: for ID 124, the PHP 10,000 was already reflected through a reduced assessment and was not deducted again at enrollment.
 - 4.14.4. The Administration further clarified that beginning with ID 125, the University has reverted to the confirmation fee system, wherein the fee paid is again deducted from the enrollment assessment.
 - 4.14.5. It was emphasized that ID 124 is the only batch subject to the admission fee arrangement and that succeeding batches will follow the previous confirmation fee practice.
- 4.15. A USG member asked why the admission fee arrangement was implemented only for ID 124.
 - 4.15.1. The Administration explained that the arrangement was introduced during the transition to a new enrollment and accounting system, when system limitations required simplification of accounting processes to avoid extensive customization.
 - 4.15.2. The Administration further clarified that with the subsequent shift to a different system capable of accommodating the previous process, the University decided to revert to the original confirmation fee system.
- 4.16. A USG member sought clarification on whether the admission fee applied only to the annual physical examination and drug testing fees.
 - 4.16.1. The Administration clarified that the PHP 10,000 admission fee consists of multiple components, including ID card, matriculation, orientation, SAS 1000, social formation, and SAS 2000, which previously comprised the new student fees, with the annual physical examination and drug testing fees added to complete the amount.
 - 4.16.2. The Administration further clarified that for ID 124, these fees are no longer reflected under miscellaneous fees, as they were already paid in advance through the admission fee.
 - 4.16.3. It was noted that for ID 125 and subsequent batches, the said items will again appear under miscellaneous fees, consistent with the reverted confirmation fee system.
- 4.17. An AFED member inquired about the classification and location of the guidance and student services fees, including whether these are paid directly to students.
 - 4.17.1. The Administration clarified that the said services are reflected under SAS fees, which appear across different year levels.
 - 4.17.2. It was noted that the specific SAS items may vary by year level, which may account for differences in how the fees appear in the schedule.
 - 4.17.3. The AFED member encouraged students, through the University Student Government (USG), to make use of the available guidance and student support services.
- 4.18. A PUSO member (ID 124) raised a concern regarding having paid separately for drug testing and physical examination prior to enrollment, noting that these items also appeared in the PHP 10,000 admission/advance fee breakdown.
 - 4.18.1. The Administration clarified that the pre-enrollment drug testing and physical examination undertaken by incoming students are requirements fulfilled through

accredited external testing centers, and that no payment is received by the University for these tests.

- 4.18.2. It was further clarified that the physical examination and drug testing fees included in the admission fee refer to those conducted during later terms, once the student is already enrolled, and are distinct from the pre-admission requirements.
- 4.18.3. The Chair reiterated that the tests required prior to confirmation serve as compliance requirements, while the fees reflected in the admission breakdown pertain to University-administered services during enrollment.
- 4.19. A USG member requested access to the Tables of Fees for AY 2023–2024 and AY 2024–2025 for comparison purposes.
- 4.19.1. The Administration confirmed that the requested Tables of Fees are available and agreed to provide the documents to the requesting party.
- 4.20. The Chair noted that questions raised by the USG may be further addressed during the Administration’s formal proposal presentation, and encouraged members to consolidate their questions in preparation for that discussion.
- 4.21. With no further comments on the Administration presentation, the Chair confirmed that the body would proceed to the Employees’ Association (EA) Proposal / Presentation.

5. Employees' Association (EA) Proposal/Presentation

- 5.1. The Chair formally opened the Employees’ Association (EA) Proposal and invited Mr. John Perez, President of the De La Salle University Employees’ Association (DLSUEA), to present.
- 5.2. Mr. Perez provided background on the DLSUEA, noting that it was organized in June 1981 and is the recognized bargaining representative of covered employees of the University.
- 5.3. The EA proposed a 6.6% Tuition Fee Increase (TFI) for AY 2026–2027, citing historical data on tuition fee increases and corresponding salary increases.
- 5.4. The EA presented data showing that, in several academic years, salary increases lagged behind tuition fee increases, including:
 - 5.4.1. AY 2020–2021: 3.5% TFI, 2.5% salary increase
 - 5.4.2. AY 2022–2023: 3.0% TFI, 2.5% salary increase
 - 5.4.3. AY 2025–2026: 3.0% TFI, 1.0% salary increase
- 5.5. The EA cited CHED-approved tuition fee increase benchmarks for private higher education institutions, noting that some institutions implemented increases ranging from 5% to 8%, while DLSU’s approved increases were comparatively lower.
- 5.6. The EA referenced Regional Inflation Rate (RIR) data and presented regional figures to support the proposed increase.
- 5.7. The EA discussed recent amendments to de minimis benefits under BIR RR No. 029-2025, noting increases in allowable non-taxable benefits but emphasizing that these benefits are not automatically granted and must still be negotiated through the CBA.
- 5.8. The EA highlighted the impact of mandatory deductions (SSS, PhilHealth, Pag-IBIG, and taxes), explaining that nominal salary increases are significantly reduced in take-home pay.
- 5.9. The EA presented examples illustrating salary computation, including salary divisors, daily and hourly rates, and how increases are offset by deductions as salaries rise.
- 5.10. The EA raised concerns regarding stagnant or reduced office budgets, institutional support activities, and staff development funding following the pandemic.
- 5.11. The EA emphasized the need for tuition fee increases to support:
 - 5.11.1. Competitive compensation
 - 5.11.2. Staff development and training
 - 5.11.3. Campus safety and infrastructure
 - 5.11.4. Technological advancement
 - 5.11.5. Talent retention and attraction
- 5.12. The EA concluded that a 6.6% tuition fee increase, anchored on RIR data, is necessary to address inflationary pressures, improve employee welfare, and support the University’s long-term institutional goals.
- 5.13. The Chair acknowledged the completion of the EA presentation and opened the floor for comments and discussions.

6. Discussions/Manifestation/Motion

- 6.1. A USG member commented on the inflation rate cited in the Employees’ Association (EA) proposal, noting that while the proposal referenced CHED data, inflation projections may vary depending on the source.

6.1.1. The USG member suggested that, for consistency and comparability, the Committee consider adopting a single baseline source for inflation data, preferably from the Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas (BSP).

6.1.2. The USG member shared that no official inflation projections for AY 2026 were readily available at the time and that reference was instead made to 2024 Regional Inflation Rate (RIR) data.

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6.1.3. The comment was noted for consideration in subsequent deliberations.

6.2. A USG member commented on the slide comparing tuition fee increases among different schools, noting that the cited institutions operate on a two-semester system, while DLSU follows a trimestral system.

6.2.1. The USG member observed that tuition fee increases may be more strongly felt by students in a trimestral system due to more frequent tuition payments within the academic year.

6.2.2. The USG member suggested that future comparisons consider institutions with academic calendars similar to DLSU, such as other trimestral universities.

6.2.3. The EA clarified that the comparative data were sourced from CHED records for private higher education institutions, and that comparable data for similarly structured institutions were not readily available at the time.

6.3. An administration provided clarification regarding the source of inflation rate data used in the discussions, noting that the Committee follows CHED guidelines since submissions are made to CHED.

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6.3.1. It was clarified that while CHED Regional Inflation Rates (RIR) are used, these figures are derived from data provided by the Bangko Sentral ng Pilipinas (BSP).

6.3.2. The distinction between the two sources was explained, with BSP data typically reflecting national inflation, while CHED uses regional inflation figures, which may be slightly higher for certain regions such as the NCR.

6.3.3. It was further noted that the CHED RIR is based on the previous year's actual inflation rate, rather than projected inflation for the succeeding year.

6.4. A USG member raised a concern regarding the perceived disparity between the Administration's financial presentation—which showed increased allocations for salaries and benefits—and the employees' reported experience, noting that some salary increases were described as relatively low in recent years.

6.4.1. The Administration responded that a detailed breakdown of allocations—showing how incremental tuition fee proceeds were distributed between salaries, benefits, and operations—would be presented in the next meeting, as previously committed.

6.4.2. The Administration explained that differences in salary increase outcomes across years are influenced by multiple factors, including:

6.4.2.1. Increases in mandatory benefit contributions (e.g., SSS contribution rate changes),

6.4.2.2. Changes in retirement and benefit costs, and

- 6.4.2.3. Variations in student enrollment, which affect the size of incremental tuition fee proceeds.
- 6.4.3. It was noted that years with higher enrollment generated larger incremental proceeds, allowing for higher salary adjustments, while years with lower enrollment resulted in smaller incremental allocations.
- 6.4.4. The Administration reiterated that, based on available data, more than 70% of incremental tuition fee proceeds were allocated to salaries and benefits, and that this would be substantiated through the forthcoming detailed presentation.
- 6.5. A USG member sought clarification on whether the Employees' Association (EA) proposal included the hiring of additional employees as a use of the proposed tuition fee increase.
 - 6.5.1. The EA clarified that its presentation did not propose increasing employee headcount, but rather emphasized the need to restore and increase operating and office budgets, which have declined in recent years, resulting in out-of-pocket expenses for employees.
 - 6.5.2. The EA further explained that improved budgets would enable employees to better support University stakeholders, particularly students.
 - 6.5.3. The Administration cautioned that increasing the number of employees would result in more recipients sharing the same 70% allocation from incremental tuition fee proceeds, potentially diluting salary and benefit increases.
 - 6.5.4. A USG member expressed concurrence with the EA's concern on declining budgets, citing similar reductions in USG operational funds over successive administrations despite tuition fee increases.
 - 6.5.5. The Administration explained that budget levels are closely tied to enrollment figures, noting that peak enrollment in AYs 2021–2022 generated higher available funds, while recent enrollment declines have resulted in tighter budgets.
 - 6.5.6. The Administration reiterated that salaries and benefits are prioritized, and that even recent modest salary increases already exceeded 70% of incremental tuition fee proceeds, leaving limited funds for other operational budgets.
 - 6.5.7. The Administration acknowledged current financial constraints and expressed hope that improved enrollment in future years would allow for expanded budget allocations.
- 6.6. A USG member asked how unutilized budgets allocated to departments and offices are treated, noting that unused funds do not appear to carry over to the following year.
 - 6.6.1. The Administration explained that budgets sourced from the General Fund are non-carryover in nature and must be returned to the General Fund if not utilized within the fiscal year.
 - 6.6.2. In contrast, the Administration clarified that restricted funds, such as laboratory fees, are not reverted and may be accumulated for future laboratory investments or contingency needs.
 - 6.6.3. The Administration emphasized the importance of maintaining a distinction between unrestricted and restricted funds, noting that unrestricted funds provide the University with financial flexibility necessary for strategic and operational needs.
 - 6.6.4. It was noted that over-restricting funds could limit the University's ability to respond effectively to changing circumstances.
- 6.7. A USG member raised a follow-up concern on why subsequent budget allocations decrease even when a unit does not fully utilize its previous budget.
 - 6.7.1. The Administration explained that in private institutions, budgets are treated as planning tools, and emphasis is placed on actual spending and utilization, rather than solely on approved budget amounts.
 - 6.7.2. It was explained that when a unit consistently underspends its allocated budget, this may indicate excess allocation or budget hoarding, prompting Finance to reallocate funds to other units with more immediate or critical needs.
 - 6.7.3. The Administration cited examples such as scholarships, athletic programs, and other priority expenditures, noting that over-allocation to under-utilizing units can limit financial flexibility.
 - 6.7.4. It was emphasized that efficient budget utilization is considered a performance indicator, and that persistent underspending may result in reduced future allocations.
 - 6.7.5. The Administration added that oversight bodies, including the Board of Trustees, raise concerns when large budgets are approved but remain unspent, as this is more difficult to justify than controlled overspending.
- 6.8. An AFED member reflected on the prolonged suspension of institutional and association-wide staff activities, such as summer outings, noting that the last institutional activity was held in 2019,

with no similar activities conducted in the succeeding years due to the pandemic and subsequent budget constraints.

- 6.8.1. The AFED member expressed hope that such wellness and morale-building activities, including a possible summer outing, may be resumed in the coming academic year to allow members of the academic community to rest and recover.
- 6.8.2. The AFED member further provided context on the salary increase structure, explaining that adjustments to salary steps and ranks for faculty were implemented as part of earlier negotiations, resulting in differentiated salary progression rather than across-the-board increases.
- 6.8.3. The Administration clarified that the transition back to across-the-board salary increases is projected around AY 2028–2029, subject to financial conditions and the magnitude of future tuition fee increases.
- 6.8.4. It was noted that higher increases in previous years facilitated progress toward across-the-board adjustments, while lower increases, such as the 1% increase in the current year, slowed this progression.
- 6.8.5. The AFED member also reiterated a previously raised suggestion on the possibility of non-annual tuition fee increases, acknowledging that the matter remains subject to further administrative evaluation.
- 6.9. An AFED member noted that the sectors received only a one-page copy of the Employees' Association (EA) proposal and requested a complete copy of the PowerPoint presentation for reference.
 - 6.9.1. The EA President agreed to distribute the full presentation to all sectors.
 - 6.9.2. The Chair acknowledged the request and thanked the EA for the commitment.

7. Other Matters

- 7.1. The Chair inquired if there were any other matters to be discussed aside from the Employees' Association (EA) presentation prior to adjournment.
- 7.2. A USG member requested permission to inform students of the matters discussed during the MSCCTF meetings, noting that students are generally aware only of the proposed tuition fee increases per sector but not the substance of the discussions.
 - 7.2.1. It was noted that the minutes of the meeting serve as the official record of discussions, and the request was clarified to involve publicizing summarized information based on the approved minutes.
 - 7.2.2. The Administration stated that there were no confidential or sensitive matters discussed during the meeting and expressed no objection to the dissemination of information, subject to sectoral agreement.
 - 7.2.3. The Chair sought the position of the other sectors, and AFED and EA expressed no objection to the request.
 - 7.2.4. The Chair approved the request, with the condition that:
 - 7.2.4.1. Any publicity material shall be based solely on the approved minutes;
 - 7.2.4.2. The content shall be consolidated and summarized, not a verbatim reproduction of the minutes; and
 - 7.2.4.3. The draft publicity material must be submitted to the Chair for circulation and approval by all sectors prior to posting.
 - 7.2.5. The USG acknowledged the conditions and committed to complying with the required approval process to ensure accuracy and consistency of information.
- 7.3. An EA representative requested whether, similar to previous MSCCTF cycles, the Administration could provide an indicative or projected salary increase equivalent corresponding to the proposed tuition fee increase, to give sectors an early reference point.
 - 7.3.1. The Administration explained that the primary determinant of salary increases is the amount of incremental tuition fee proceeds, which is significantly affected by student enrollment levels for the upcoming academic year.
 - 7.3.2. It was clarified that due to significant fluctuations in student intake in recent years, the Administration is currently unable to commit to an indicative salary increase percentage, as enrollment figures are only more reliably assessed closer to confirmation periods.
 - 7.3.3. The EA requested access to historical enrollment data to better understand enrollment trends and their impact on tuition fee proceeds and salary adjustments.
 - 7.3.4. The Administration agreed to present historical enrollment figures, starting from AY 2020, including periods of enrollment surges and subsequent declines.

- 7.3.5. It was agreed that the requested enrollment data will be presented at the start of the next meeting, together with other pending financial data previously requested, prior to further sectoral deliberations.
- 7.4. An EA representative raised a concern regarding information that the University had set a target freshman intake of approximately 5,000 students, which was not met, and noted perceptions that the shortfall contributed to the lower salary increase.
 - 7.4.1. The EA representative emphasized that employees and faculty are not responsible for enrollment outcomes, and expressed the need for clearer communication and shared understanding of how enrollment targets affect University finances and employee welfare.
 - 7.4.2. The Administration clarified that the 5,500 freshman intake target was based on financial sustainability projections made in 2022, particularly in relation to the extension of the retirement age from 60 to 65, which increased long-term operational requirements.
 - 7.4.3. It was explained that the highest pre-pandemic freshman intake was approximately 4,500 students, and that reaching 5,500 has consistently been challenging, though it remains an aspirational target.
 - 7.4.4. The Administration stated that failure to meet enrollment targets results in lower revenue, necessitating cost-containment measures, including reduced salary increases and tighter operational budgets, to ensure institutional sustainability.
 - 7.4.5. The Administration emphasized that expenditures cannot exceed revenues, as doing so would threaten the long-term viability of the University and negatively affect all stakeholders.
 - 7.4.6. The EA representative acknowledged the explanation and expressed the importance of collective planning and transparency, noting that employees are likewise concerned with the University's stability, as their livelihood depends on it.
 - 7.4.7. The Administration underscored that improving quality of education, student experience, and campus facilities remains a key strategy to attract students, and cited ongoing system improvements, including Archer's Hub and future HR and financial information systems, to enhance service delivery.
- 7.5. The Chair relayed a concern raised regarding the possibility of redundancy or duplication of work among employees.
 - 7.5.1. The Administration clarified that the University is currently studying its workforce requirements as part of ongoing operational assessment.
 - 7.5.2. The Administration emphasized that the University's approach to workforce assessment is not centered on termination or downsizing, but on identifying how employees may be redeployed or assigned additional roles to improve service delivery.
 - 7.5.3. It was noted that the intent of the assessment is to enhance student and employee experience, address operational gaps, and ensure that all personnel are meaningfully engaged, rather than to remove positions deemed redundant.
 - 7.5.4. The Administration acknowledged concerns about employee apprehension regarding workforce assessments and reiterated its commitment to a developmental and non-punitive approach.

8. Schedule of Next Meeting

- 8.1. The Chair reminded the body that the next meeting will feature the University Student Government (USG) presentation and advised members to reserve questions and comments for the Administration's presentation.
 - 8.1.1. A USG representative requested that the scheduled 3:00 PM meeting be moved to 4:00 PM, citing academic commitments of several USG representatives.
 - 8.1.2. The Chair sought the consensus of the sectors regarding the proposed time adjustment.
 - 8.1.3. No objections were raised by the Administration, AFED, or the Employees' Association (EA).
- 8.2. By consensus, the Committee agreed to reschedule the next MSCCTF meeting to 4:00 PM on 21 January 2026.

9. Adjournment

- 9.1. With no other matters raised, a motion to adjourn the meeting was made by an AFED member
- 9.2. The motion was duly seconded by a USG member.
- 9.3. The Chair declared the meeting adjourned, with the next meeting scheduled for 21 January 2026 at 4:00 PM.



UNIVERSITY STUDENT GOVERNMENT

Prepared by:


Mr. Lucas Antonio V. Tujan
USG Executive Secretary
DLSU USG

Noted and Validated by:

Ms. Maria Lourdes Fajardo
Chairperson, MSCCTF
President and CEO
DLSU-PUSO



4th Multi-Sectoral Consultative Committee on Tuition Fees (MSCCTF) Minutes of the Meeting

The meeting was called to order by **DLSU PUSO** on
January 21, 2026 4:00 PM via **Zoom**

DATE	January 21, 2026
TIME	4:00 PM
SCRIBE	Lucas Antonio V Tujan, <i>USG Executive Secretary</i>

ATTENDANCE	
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR ADMIN	Dr. Robert Roleda Ms. Kai Shan Fernandez Mr. Jirk Jansen Miranda
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR AFED	Dr. David Michael San Juan Mr. Rommel Billena Dr. Raymond Vergara
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR EA	Mr. John Perez IV Ms. Marileth Recaido Ms. Pinky Villanueva and
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR PUSO	Ms. Maria Lourdes Fajardo Ms. Maela Lumabas Ms. Shiela Nacpil Ms. Rosalyn Villano
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR USG	Ms. Lara Capps Ms. Lucas Antonio Tujan Mr. Jeian Ruiz Nicol Ms. Micah Agatha Dimatulac

AGENDA SUMMARY

1. Invocation - USG
- 1.1. The Chair invited the University Student Government (USG) to lead the invocation.

1.1.1. The prayer was led by a USG representative, Nio Tujan
2. Call to Order
- 2.1. The Chair, Ms. Maria Lourdes Fajardo, formally called the 4th Multisectoral Consultative Committee on Tuition Fee (MSCCTF) Meeting to order at 4:00 PM on 21 January 2026 via Zoom.

2.2. The Chair directed the Executive Secretary to conduct the roll call of attendance.

2.2.1. Members from the Administration, AFED, EA, PUSO, and USG were recorded as present

2.2.2. Dr. Raymond Vergara was confirmed present during the second roll call.

2.3. With a quorum established, the Chair formally called the meeting to order.
3. Reading and Approval of the Minutes of the 3rd MSCCTF Meeting 14 January 2026
- 3.1. The Chair stated that the minutes of the 3rd MSCCTF Meeting held on 14 January 2026 had been circulated prior to the meeting.

3.1.1. With no corrections or objections raised, a motion to approve the minutes was made by a member of the Administration.

- 3.1.2. The motion was duly seconded by an EA member.
- 3.2. The minutes of the 3rd MSCCTF Meeting were approved.

4. **Business Arising**

- 4.1. The Chair invited the Administration to present the data requested in the previous meeting regarding the breakdown of tuition fee increases and allocation to salaries and benefits.
- 4.2. A representative of the Administration presented the breakdown of tuition fee increases for the past four academic years, computed using the Supreme Court-prescribed formula, separating incremental proceeds due to tuition fee increases from those due to changes in enrollment.
 - 4.2.1. It was reported that the incremental proceeds from tuition fee increases for the past three academic years ranged from PHP 136 million to PHP 234 million.
 - 4.2.2. The Administration presented the corresponding increases in salaries and benefits, amounting to PHP 119 million, PHP 473 million, and PHP 388 million for the same period.
 - 4.2.3. The breakdown showed that the largest portion of allocations went to basic pay increases, with additional indirect costs incurred through related benefits such as:
 - 4.2.3.1. Retirement contributions
 - 4.2.3.2. Leave and longevity benefits
 - 4.2.3.3. SSS and PhilHealth premium increases
 - 4.2.4. The Administration explained that employees hired before 01 September 2022 are covered by a defined benefit retirement plan, which results in retroactive cost implications whenever basic pay is increased, while employees hired after that date are under a defined contribution plan with purely prospective cost effects.
 - 4.2.5. Data on year-on-year salary growth showed overall increases ranging from 5.21% to 8.26%, which included both across-the-board salary increase and promotions.
 - 4.2.6. It was noted that the total cost of salary and benefit increases exceeded the incremental proceeds from tuition fee increases, with allocations reaching more than 100% of incremental proceeds, thereby reducing funds available for other operational purposes.
 - 4.2.7. The Administration clarified that changes in employee headcount were largely due to a decline in part-time faculty, and not to expansion of the workforce.
 - 4.2.8. The Administration also presented the undergraduate enrollment trend, noting:
 - 4.2.8.1. Pre-K–12 average population of about 15,000 students
 - 4.2.8.2. Peak intake during AY 2021–2022 and AY 2022–2023
 - 4.2.8.3. Decline in intake to 4,386 students for AY 2025–2026 against a target of 5,500
 - 4.2.8.4. Resulting decline in total undergraduate population from 22,000 to 21,000
 - 4.2.9. It was projected that undergraduate enrollment may continue to decline in the coming years due to the graduation of peak-intake cohorts, unless intake targets are achieved.
 - 4.2.10. The Administration summarized that most incremental tuition fee proceeds over the past three years were allocated to salaries and benefits, with the University absorbing additional costs to sustain compensation levels.
- 4.3. The Chair thanked the presenter and opened the floor for comments.
- 4.4. The EA raised concerns on the creation of new positions and their impact on salary increases, and asked whether feasibility studies were conducted prior to their creation.
 - 4.4.1. The administration explained that the increase in full-time faculty was due to higher enrollment levels and instructional requirements, resulting in an increase from approximately 500 to 600 faculty members.
 - 4.4.2. The administration further explained that the AAPP category was created based on an external compensation benchmarking study to rationalize salary structures and improve competitiveness. Existing APSP and ASF personnel will remain under their current categories, while new hires will be classified as AAPP. The current financial impact is minimal due to the small number of AAPP personnel.
 - 4.4.3. Regarding Office Manager positions, the administration stated that these were created to reduce faculty deloading from non-academic tasks, resulting in operational efficiency and the equivalent of approximately eleven (11) full-time faculty loads being freed.
 - 4.4.4. On the Across-the-Board (ATB) salary increase, AFED clarified that its return depends on available salary increases, as adjustments aim to correct salary structure disparities and are constrained by limited annual increase rates.
- 4.5. The Chair noted that further clarifications may be raised during the Administration's presentation and proceeded to the USG presentation.

5. University Student Government (USG) Proposal/Presentation

- 5.1. The USG presented its proposal advocating for a 0% tuition fee increase for AY 2026–2027, framed under the position of “Sustainable Tuition Fees.”
- 5.2. The USG stated that its proposal was grounded on historical inflation trends, student survey results, focus group discussions (FGDs), and reviewed university financial data.
- 5.3. The USG cited national inflation trends, noting that inflation declined from a post-pandemic peak and was projected to remain low and stable for 2026–2027. The USG argued that under CHED guidance, tuition increases are justified only when inflationary pressures are significant; hence, a 0% increase was presented as appropriate.
- 5.4. The USG presented student financial capacity data, stating that many students come from households with multiple dependents and that a significant portion of respondents reported delayed tuition payments and/or outstanding balances. The USG emphasized that limited access to scholarships or formal financial aid increases student vulnerability to tuition adjustments.
- 5.5. The USG reported that affordability concerns are affecting retention, citing survey findings that a portion of students have considered transferring, filing leave of absence (LOA), or using promissory notes due to financial constraints.
- 5.6. The USG cited enrollment trends, noting a decline in total enrollment from AY 2024–2025 Term 1 (27,729 students) to AY 2025–2026 Term 1 (26,723 students), and stated that rising costs may influence decisions to defer or discontinue enrollment.
- 5.7. The USG reported that promissory note eligibility has become more restrictive based on consultations with the Finance and Accounting Office (FAO), and noted a decrease in promissory note usage, which the USG attributed to tighter eligibility rather than improved financial capacity. The USG also noted that the student loan program was discontinued and presented this as a reduction in institutional support.
- 5.8. The USG presented an assessment of the University’s financial standing and efficiency, citing indicators such as the operating reserve ratio and trends showing that operating expenses increased faster than tuition-based revenues. The USG recommended prioritizing cost control, expenditure efficiency, and alternative income-generation measures instead of increasing tuition.
- 5.9. The USG discussed capital expenditures (CAPEX), noting unutilized balances and recommending improved utilization and implementation efficiency, stating that tuition increases should not be pursued while capital resources remain underutilized.
- 5.10. The USG raised policy concerns regarding the procurement and potential renewal of online proctoring tools (e.g., lockdown browser/respondus monitor), citing student concerns regarding device permissions and cost implications. The USG recommended discontinuing subscription expenditures and instead redesigning assessments to be more cheating-resistant.
- 5.11. The USG recommended a review of double-degree program curricula, citing student feedback on redundant and overlapping courses and proposing streamlining measures such as crediting equivalent courses or merging subjects to reduce unit load while maintaining academic rigor.
- 5.12. The USG recommended increasing the University’s scholarship and financial aid support, citing a need to expand allocation and improve accessibility of assistance, and noting increased demand for student-sector financial support initiatives.
- 5.13. The USG raised concerns regarding hidden or additional costs from course requirements and recommended exploring centralized institutional licensing for learning platforms and materials to reduce out-of-pocket student expenses.
- 5.14. The USG reiterated concerns regarding the ID 124 reservation/admission fee classification, presented its computation on possible overcharge risk, and requested clarification and possible alignment with the standard medical fee and tuition credit practice.
- 5.15. The USG concluded by reiterating that tuition has become increasingly unsustainable for students and emphasized that its recommendations aim to reduce the financial burden and protect student access and retention.

6. Discussions/Manifestation/Motion

- 6.1. After the USG presentation, the Chair opened the floor for discussion.
- 6.2. The Administration clarified that the University’s actual tuition fee increases have never exceeded the inflation rate and are often less than half or one-third of inflation based on historical implementation.
- 6.3. The Administration explained that the online proctoring software (Respondus) is currently under a free trial. No licenses have been purchased for the entire student population, as pilot testing is conducted prior to any subscription, and no significant expenditure has been incurred.
- 6.4. On scholarships, the Administration stated that the reported 20% scholar population refers to full scholar equivalents as provided by the Admissions and Scholarship Office.

- 6.5. The Administration reported recent policy adjustments on scholarships, including:
 - 6.5.1. The increase of the family income threshold for eligibility from ₱800,000 to ₱1.8 million to include middle-income families;
 - 6.5.2. Full tuition waivers for students with family income below ₱1 million;
 - 6.5.3. Stipends for students with family income below ₱450,000; and
 - 6.5.4. Partial scholarships for students with family income between ₱1 million and ₱1.8 million, with an increased number of available slots.
 - 6.5.5. These revisions shall be implemented starting with the next batch of incoming students.
- 6.6. The USG clarified that its reference to inflation pertained to previous tuition fee increase proposals rather than actual implemented rates.
- 6.7. The USG emphasized that inflation has significantly declined since 2024 and is projected to remain stable, and on this basis reiterated its position that tuition fee increases for the coming academic year should be lower or possibly at 0%.
- 6.8. On examinations and unpaid dues, the Administration clarified that students are not prevented from taking examinations due to unpaid balances, provided they are officially enrolled.
- 6.9. The Administration further clarified that outstanding balances may affect eligibility for subsequent enrollment but not examinations within the current term.
- 6.10. On promissory notes and surcharge, the Administration stated that the surcharge is imposed primarily as a disciplinary measure to encourage timely payment and that filing a promissory note generally prevents the imposition of surcharge.
- 6.11. The USG raised concerns regarding stricter limitations on the approval of promissory notes and the burden of accumulated surcharge fees on students.
- 6.12. On payment posting and surcharge discrepancies, it was noted that some payment channels are not real-time, which may result in posting delays.
- 6.13. The Administration clarified that if payment is verified to have been made before the deadline, any surcharge imposed may be reversed.
- 6.14. The Administration stated that a grace period may be implemented to account for posting delays, especially when deadlines fall on weekends.
- 6.15. The USG raised reports that the surcharge may have increased to ₱1,000.
- 6.16. The Administration committed to verify the system configuration and policy implementation and to provide an update in the next meeting.
- 6.17. On curriculum redundancy, the USG reported that students, particularly those in double-degree programs, experienced overlapping course content based on surveys and focus group discussions.
- 6.18. The Administration committed to elevate the concern on curriculum redundancy to the appropriate academic units for possible curriculum review.
- 6.19. The EA requested that future responses and clarifications by the Administration be supported with statistics and relevant documents where applicable.
- 6.20. The Chair reminded all parties that deliberations on tuition fee adjustments are ongoing and not yet final and encouraged careful and responsible public communication of proposals and discussions.

7. Other Matters

- 7.1. The Chair reiterated that deliberations on the proposed tuition fee increase are ongoing and that no final recommendation has been reached.
- 7.2. The USG confirmed that its complete proposal will be circulated to all sectors following the meeting.
- 7.3. The Administration recommended preparing a comparative matrix of proposals from all sectors (USG, AFED, EA, and Administration) to guide future discussions.
- 7.4. The Chair reminded all sectors to exercise caution in public communications regarding tuition fee matters to prevent misinformation and premature conclusions.
- 7.5. Concerns on late payment surcharges, promissory note restrictions, and enrollment-related processes were acknowledged and noted for coordination with the Finance and Accounting Office and the Enrollment Council.
- 7.6. The Administration committed to reviewing the implementation of surcharge policies, including possible system discrepancies and the application of grace periods for delayed payment posting.
- 7.7. Issues raised on curriculum redundancy in double-degree programs and the use of HyFlex classrooms were noted for referral to the appropriate academic units for review.
- 7.8. The next set of sectoral proposals will be presented in the succeeding meetings as part of the ongoing consultation process.

8. Schedule of Next Meeting

- 8.1. The Chair informed the body that the schedule of the next MSCCTF meeting will be January 28, 2026 at 3:00 PM.
- 8.2. It was agreed that subsequent sectoral proposals will be presented in the next meeting as part of the continuing consultation process.
- 8.3. Members were advised to prepare their respective inputs and supporting data for the next scheduled discussion.

9. **Adjournment**

- 9.1. The administration moved to adjourn the meeting.
- 9.2. The motion was seconded by the EA.
- 9.3. The Chair declared the meeting adjourned.

Prepared by:


Mr. Lucas Antonio V F. Tujan
USG Executive Secretary
DLSU USG

Noted and Validated by:

Ms. Maria Lourdes Fajardo
Chairperson, MSCCTF
President and CEO
DLSU-PUSO



5th Multi-Sectoral Consultative Committee on Tuition Fees (MSCCTF) Minutes of the Meeting

The meeting was called to order by **DLSU PUSO** on
January 28, 2026 3:00 PM via **Zoom**

DATE	January 28, 2026
TIME	3:00 PM
SCRIBE	Lucas Antonio V F. Tujan, <i>USG Executive Secretary</i>

ATTENDANCE	
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR ADMIN	Dr. Robert Roleda Ms. Kai Shan Fernandez Mr. Jirk Jansen Miranda
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR AFED	Dr. David Michael San Juan Mr. Rommel Billena Dr. Raymond Vergara
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR EA	Mr. John Perez IV Ms. Marileth Recaido Ms. Pinky Villanueva
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR PUSO	Ms. Maria Lourdes Fajardo Ms. Maela Lumabas Ms. Shiela Nacpil Ms. Rosalyn Villano
MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE FOR USG	Ms. Lara Capps Ms. Lucas Antonio Tujan Mr. Jeian Ruiz Nicol Ms. Micah Agatha Dimatulac

AGENDA SUMMARY

- XV. Invocation - PUSO
 - A. The meeting opened with an invocation led by the Parents of University Students Organization (PUSO).
 - B. The prayer asked for guidance, wisdom, unity, and honesty in the deliberations of the committee.
- XVI. Call to Order
 - A. The Chair called the meeting to order after the invocation.
 - B. The Board Secretary conducted the roll call of attendance.
 - C. A second roll call was conducted to confirm attendance.
 - D. With a quorum present, the Chair declared the meeting duly constituted.
- XVII. Reading and Approval of the Minutes of the 4th MSCCTF Meeting 21 January 2026
 - A. Under Item 4.2.5 (Business Arising) of the previous minutes, the AFED member clarified that the reported year-on-year salary growth of 5.21% to 8.26% consisted of:
 - 1. Across-the-board salary increases (for CAP, APSP, full-time, and PSF); and
 - 2. Salary increases due to promotions.
 - B. The clarification was noted for the record and incorporated into the minutes.

- C. With no other corrections or objections raised, a motion to approve the minutes of the Fourth MSCCTF Meeting was made by an AFED member.
- D. The motion was seconded by an administration member.
- E. The minutes of the Fourth MSCCTF Meeting were approved.

XVIII. Business Arising

- A. The Administration reported on the investigation of the ₱1,000 surcharge collected on 2 January 2026. It was confirmed that an error occurred in the system configuration, resulting in the imposition of excess surcharge.
- B. The Administration announced that the excess surcharge of ₱500 will be reversed automatically through adjustments in Archer's Hub once balances are posted. No action will be required from affected students.
- C. The USG inquired about the process of correction for students who already paid ₱1,000. The Administration clarified that the adjustment will appear as a ₱500 deduction in the students' account balances.
- D. The Administration explained that the error resulted from miscommunication between the Finance Office and the Office of the University Registrar (OUR) regarding the start date of surcharge implementation. It was stated that future coordination will be improved to prevent recurrence.
- E. The USG requested assurance that the error will not recur in succeeding terms and asked for a finalized communication plan. The Administration committed to improve system alignment and policy implementation moving forward.
- F. The Administration confirmed that affected students will be formally notified, either through email, Archer's Hub, or Canvas, after determining the most effective communication platform.
- G. It was clarified that the cashiering operations will resume on 29 January 2026, and this information may be disseminated to students.
- H. Concerns raised regarding misinformation circulating on social media were acknowledged. The Administration emphasized the importance of issuing an official clarification to ensure accurate and consistent information is shared with students.
- I. With no further questions raised, the Chair closed the discussion on Business Arising.

XIX. Parents of University Students Organization (PUSO) Proposal/Presentation

- A. The Parents of University Students Organization (PUSO) presented its proposal for the tuition fee adjustment for Academic Year 2026–2027, recommending a 0% tuition fee increase.
- B. PUSO explained that many families are experiencing continued financial strain due to the rising cost of living, limited salary growth, and unstable employment conditions, making additional tuition increases difficult to absorb.
- C. PUSO reported that the demand for tuition-related assistance has increased over recent years, with the total amount of assistance rising from ₱3.10 million in AY 2022–2023 to ₱4.03 million in AY 2024–2025, indicating greater financial need among parents.
- D. PUSO identified groups most affected by tuition increases, including:
 - 1. Middle-income families who receive little or no scholarship support;
 - 2. Single-income and single-parent households; and
 - 3. Families facing job insecurity or reduced business income.
- E. PUSO expressed concern that further tuition increases may lead to delayed payments, increased reliance on promissory notes, leaves of absence, or student withdrawals, which may negatively affect both families and University enrollment.
- F. PUSO highlighted its continuing contributions to the University through funding of student activities and provision of tuition assistance via the Tuition Fee Assistance (TFA), College Intervention Fund (CIF), and Lifeline programs.
- G. PUSO recommended:
 - 1. Maintaining a 0% tuition fee increase for AY 2026–2027;
 - 2. Exploring multi-year tuition planning instead of annual adjustments; and
 - 3. Ensuring clearer communication and transparency in tuition deliberations involving all sectors.
- H. PUSO affirmed its commitment to participate actively in University consultations and to continue supporting students and families through its assistance programs.

XX. Discussions/Manifestation/Motion

- A. After the PUSO presentation, the Chair opened the floor for comments and reactions.
- B. A question was raised on how many times a student may avail of PUSO financial assistance and the corresponding amount.

1. PUSO clarified that financial assistance is generally granted once through the College Intervention Fund (CIF) in the amount of ₱25,000 for a student's stay in the University.
2. PUSO further explained that after two terms, a student may request an additional ₱15,000, and graduating students may request a ₱10,000 lifeline assistance.
- C. A concern was raised regarding the photocopying, scanning, and printing services near the clinic, including questions on its management and the availability of financial reporting.
 1. The Chair clarified that the service is currently managed by SCOOP, and neither PUSO nor the USG manages it at present.
 2. It was shared that discussions are ongoing on whether the University should require rental payment or review the current arrangement, and whether rent-free use should depend on whether proceeds benefit the student body.
 3. It was noted that a meeting with the concerned offices and organizations was scheduled the following week to further discuss the matter.
 4. PUSO stated its willingness to explore managing a similar service if feasible, subject to coordination and board discussion.
- D. A suggestion was raised to consider wellness facilities (e.g., massage chairs) within the University as a stress-relief option for students and employees. The suggestion was noted.
- E. An EA representative thanked the Administration for prior negotiations and raised concern that a 0% tuition fee increase may affect salary increases and University services, citing statutory tuition allocation rules (70-20-10).
- F. The USG clarified that the allocation rules apply only if there is a tuition fee increase and do not mandate annual tuition increases.
 1. The USG cited unutilized capital expenditure allocations and recommended budget reallocation and the exploration of other income sources to support salaries without increasing tuition.
- G. The EA reiterated concerns on how the University can sustain improvements, including technology, without tuition increases, and referenced limitations on restricted funds.
 1. A correction was raised regarding the legal reference, noting that Republic Act 6728 had been amended by Republic Act 8545.
 2. Tension was noted during the exchange, and the Chair redirected the discussion to maintain respect among sectors.
- H. The Administration emphasized that salaries, operations, and capital expenditures must be balanced, noting that prioritizing one area at the expense of facilities has long-term consequences.
- I. A parent representative asked whether faculty evaluations and employee appraisals are considered in determining salary increases.
 1. The Administration clarified that evaluations affect promotions and that salary increases consist of two components: promotion-based increases and across-the-board increases.
- J. The Administration explained that APSP is not included as a voting sector in the MSCCTF to preserve sectoral balance, but may participate in discussions without voting rights.
 1. The EA stated that it does not agree to APSP inclusion as a voting sector and noted that APSP may organize separately if it so chooses.
- K. The USG reiterated that existing guidelines regulate tuition increases if implemented, but do not require annual tuition increases.
 1. The EA clarified that it was not claiming increases are mandatory, but emphasized compliance with law and the realities of inflation and wage pressures.
 2. The USG reiterated that inflation has declined, supporting its position that tuition fee increases may be unnecessary or should remain low and sustainable.
- L. A question was raised on whether the University offers a study-now-pay-later mechanism.
 1. The Administration clarified that the University does not implement a student loan system due to financial risks and mission alignment; students may explore CHED mechanisms if available, while promissory notes remain as relief measures.
- M. The USG reiterated that it is not against institutional improvements and seeks a tuition outcome that is sustainable for students.
- N. PUSO stated that whatever tuition increase is decided, parents hope that students will clearly benefit, particularly through improvements and student welfare services.

XXI. Other Matters

- A. A USG representative requested permission to upload and publicize the approved minutes of MSCCTF meetings to promote transparency, noting that students are largely unaware of the discussions behind sectoral proposals and that misconceptions persist.

1. The Chair expressed concern that publishing full minutes may expose the Committee to misinterpretation and online bashing, and noted that meeting highlights are already being released.
 2. The Administration expressed reservations about releasing full minutes, explaining that social media discussions are difficult to control and that publishing complete minutes may lead to confusion due to selective interpretation.
 3. The EA raised related concerns, noting that faculty and staff may also be subjected to cyberbullying and cautioning against overexposure of sectoral proposals and personalities reflected in full minutes.
 4. The USG proposed posting meeting highlights instead of full minutes. The Administration agreed in principle but emphasized the need for careful selection of highlights.
 5. The Administration recommended that highlights for public release should be determined by the sector that presented, to avoid misrepresentation. The Chair reiterated that the release of full minutes would not be allowed.
- B. As a compromise, it was agreed that each sector may prepare a short summary (one to two paragraphs) of its key points for public dissemination, subject to circulation and alignment prior to posting.
- C. The Chair directed that sector-prepared summaries may be released prior to the Administration's presentation and that public releases should focus on key points rather than full documents.

XXII. Schedule of Next Meeting

- A. The Committee agreed that the next meeting will be face-to-face to support final deliberations.
- B. The next meeting was scheduled on 04 February 2026 (Tuesday) at 2:00 PM.
- C. The venue was set as To Be Announced (TBA), with the Administration to secure an appropriate room (preferably a boardroom or sufficiently large venue) and inform all sectors.
- D. Sectors were requested to provide estimated headcount (including staff/support attendees, if any) to help finalize venue arrangements.

XXIII. Adjournment

- A. The Mr. Rommel Billena moved to adjourn the meeting.
- B. The motion was seconded by Mr. John Perez IV.
- C. The Chair declared the meeting adjourned.
- D. The meeting concluded at exactly 5:05 PM



UNIVERSITY STUDENT GOVERNMENT

Prepared by:


Mr. Lucas Antonio V F. Tujan
USG Executive Secretary
DLSU USG

Noted and Validated by:

Ms. Maria Lourdes Fajardo
Chairperson, MSCCTF
President and CEO
DLSU-PUSO

6th Multi-Sectoral Consultative Committee on Tuition Fees (MSCCTF) Minutes of the Meeting

The meeting was called to order by DLSU PUSO on February 4, 2026 2:00 PM at the Villavicencio Boardroom	
DATE	February 4, 2026
TIME	2:00 PM
SCRIBE	Lucas Antonio V F. Tujan , <i>USG Executive Secretary</i>

ATTENDANCE	
MEMBERS ATTENDANCE FOR ADMIN IN	Dr. Robert Roleda Ms. Kai Shan Fernandez Mr. Jirk Jansen Miranda
MEMBERS ATTENDANCE FOR AFED IN	Dr. David Michael San Juan Mr. Rommel Billena
MEMBERS ATTENDANCE FOR EA IN	Mr. John Perez IV Ms. Marileth Recaido Ms. Pinky Villanueva
MEMBERS ATTENDANCE FOR PUSO IN	Ms. Maria Lourdes Fajardo Ms. Rosalyn Villano
MEMBERS ATTENDANCE FOR USG IN	Ms. Lara Capps Ms. Lucas Antonio Tujan Mr. Jeian Ruiz Nicol Ms. Micah Agatha Dimatulac

AGENDA SUMMARY

1. Invocation - Administration
 - 1.1. The meeting opened with an invocation led by Ms. Kai Shan Fernandez of the Administration.
 - 1.2. The prayer asked for guidance, wisdom, and unity in the committee's deliberations.
2. Call to Order
 - 2.1. The Board Secretary conducted the roll call.
 - 2.2. It was noted that Dr. Raymond Vergara, Ms. Maela Lumabas, and Ms. Shiela Nacpil were initially absent, while Mr. Miranda and Ms. Recaido arrived shortly after the roll call.
 - 2.3. With a quorum present, the Chair declared the meeting duly constituted.
3. Reading and Approval of the Minutes of the 5th MSCCTF Meeting 28 January 2026
 - 3.1. The minutes of the 5th MSCCTF Meeting held on January 28, 2026, were presented for review.
 - 3.2. The Administration moved for approval, which was seconded by AFED.
 - 3.3. The minutes were approved without further corrections.
4. Administration Proposal/Presentation
 - 4.1. The Administration reported that the University experienced a high freshman intake during the 2021 and 2022 pandemic years.
 - 4.2. This growth raised the undergraduate population to the 23,000 level.
 - 4.3. The rise in the student population historically enabled the University to provide salary increases for faculty and staff without increasing the tuition rate.
 - 4.4. To support the needs of this higher student population, the number of full-time faculty members and staff was increased during those years.

- 4.5. The Administration noted that most students from ID 121 have graduated, and most from ID 122 are currently graduating.
- 4.6. Freshman intake for ID 123 to ID 125 has declined to a range of 4,300 to 5,000 students, causing overall enrolment levels to trend downward.
- 4.7. It was emphasized that if the enrollment level continues to decline, the University will be unable to sustain the costs associated with the current number of full-time faculty and staff.
- 4.8. Projections indicate that if freshman intake stays at 5,000, the undergraduate population will decrease to 20,000.
- 4.9. If the intake stays at the 4,300 level, the population will decrease further to 17,200.
- 4.10. The Administration stated that meeting enrollment targets is critical: the security of tenure for faculty and staff can only be guaranteed if the freshman intake is at least 5,500.
- 4.11. The Administration reported that the Philippine inflation rate in 2025 was 1.7%.
- 4.12. If a tuition fee increase were pegged to the inflation rate while enrollment declines, the resulting 70% of incremental proceeds would be insufficient to cover base salary adjustments.
- 4.13. Without a tuition rate increase, any adjustments to employee compensation will depend entirely on actual enrolment numbers.
- 4.14. The Administration concluded that it is more practical at this time to focus on meeting enrolment targets rather than increasing tuition fees.
- 4.15. Based on these considerations, the Administration is not proposing a tuition fee increase for AY 2026–2027.
- 4.16. The university had high intake during the pandemic years and the population has rose to 23 thousand
- 4.17. The administration mentioned the intake range to be going down,
- 4.18. The administration mentions that not being able to maintain the level of intakes will not be able to sustainably manage payments requirements of the university
- 4.19. The administration mentions if the frosh intake stays at 5000 will maintain, then the population will be at 20000.
- 4.20. If tuition fee is pegged at inflation rate, the resulting 70% of incremental proceeds will be small
- 4.21. If there is no tuition fee increase, any employee compensation will depend on actual enrolment numbers
- 4.22. The administration will further focus on increasing enrollment intake instead of increasing tuition fee
- 4.23. The administration is therefore not proposing a tuition fee increase
5. Discussions/Manifestation/Motion
 - 5.1. Sectoral Inquiries and Clarifications
 - 5.1.1. AFED inquired if salary increases would still be implemented despite the proposed 0% tuition fee increase.
 - 5.1.2. The Administration clarified that employee compensation adjustments will depend on actual enrolment numbers and the University's success in meeting its freshman intake targets.
 - 5.1.3. AFED requested data regarding the current applicant pool. The Administration reported that there are approximately 18,000 DCAT takers, with a special DCAT scheduled to follow.
 - 5.1.4. The Administration noted that while interest is high, actual document submission and exam scheduling remain below traditional levels.
 - 5.1.5. EA raised concerns regarding the decreasing budget and its potential impact on faculty and staff.
 - 5.1.6. The Administration explained that because tuition is the primary income source, the budget is directly tied to enrollment figures.
 - 5.1.7. It was noted that additional staff were hired during pandemic surge years to support the undergraduate population of 23,000, and current staffing levels may not be sustainable if enrolment continues to decline.
 - 5.2. Enrolment and Marketing Strategies
 - 5.2.1. The Administration detailed strategies to reach the 5,500 freshman intake target required to guarantee security of tenure.
 - 5.2.2. A new online DCAT will be implemented this cycle to target the PhilAm and international markets, positioning the University as a high quality, lower cost alternative to US institutions.
 - 5.2.3. The Administration reported that Archers Hub is being used to track the 38,000 students who showed interest, identifying that only 21,000 proceeded to take the exam due to various difficulties in the application process.

- 5.2.4. AFED suggested releasing more student testimonials and experiences to highlight the University's transition back to face to face classes.
- 5.2.5. The Administration emphasized that providing value and quality service is the most effective marketing strategy, noting that current service request backlogs must be addressed to prevent losing potential applicants.
- 5.2.6. USG manifested its commitment to support enrollment by providing information on student aid and expanding fundraising activities to increase scholarship subsidies.
- 5.2.7. USG further noted that policy improvements, such as the potential abolition of the dress code, could enhance the University's appeal to prospective students.
- 6. Deliberation
 - 6.1. Deliberations on Job Security and Retrenchment
 - 6.1.1. The Committee entered a recess for sectoral deliberations.
 - 6.1.2. Upon reconvening, AFED and EA manifested their support for the 0% tuition fee increase contingent on a commitment from the Administration regarding job security.
 - 6.1.3. EA and AFED requested a written guarantee that there would be no retrenchment or removal of faculty and staff during this period.
 - 6.1.4. The Administration stated it cannot provide a blind commitment without final June enrolment figures but reassured the sectors that retrenchment is always considered a last resort.
 - 6.1.5. The Administration noted that despite incurring deficits from 2016 to 2021, the University maintained its workforce and even provided salary increases.
 - 6.1.6. To improve marketing efforts, a proposal was made for all sectors to meet with STRATCOM to provide concrete suggestions on departmental marketing and institutional visibility.
 - 6.1.7. PUSO affirmed its support for the 0% proposal and urged all sectors to collaborate on meeting the freshman intake goal to ensure financial stability.
 - 6.2. Voting and Results
 - 6.2.1. A motion to proceed with the voting was raised and seconded.
 - 6.2.2. The sectors voted as follows:
 - 6.2.2.1. USG: In favor of 0% increase.
 - 6.2.2.2. Administration: In favor of 0% increase.
 - 6.2.2.3. PUSO: In favor of 0% increase.
 - 6.2.2.4. EA: In favor of 0% increase, noting their requests for job security and collaboration.
 - 6.2.2.5. AFED: In favor of 0% increase.
 - 6.2.3. The Chair declared that there will be no tuition fee increase for Academic Year 2026–2027.
- 7. Other Matters
 - 7.1. The USG requested clarification regarding the public release of the current deliberation status to the student body.
 - 7.2. The Chair approved the request, allowing for the dissemination of information concerning the ongoing meeting outcomes.
 - 7.3. AFED suggested that the public release should include specific details regarding the DCAT to provide a comprehensive update to the University community.
 - 7.4. The meeting concluded with the formal signing of the final agreement for a 0% tuition fee increase by the EA President, the Provost, the AFED President, the PUSO Chairperson, and the USG President.
- 8. Adjournment
 - 8.1. The Chair officially moved to adjourn the session following the conclusion of all agenda items.
 - 8.2. The meeting was adjourned at exactly 4:47 PM.



UNIVERSITY STUDENT GOVERNMENT

Prepared by:


Mr. Lucas Antonio V F. Tujan
USG Executive Secretary
DLSU USG

Noted and Validated by:

Ms. Maria Lourdes Fajardo
Chairperson, MSCCTF
President and CEO
DLSU-PUSO